

NovaTech Solutions - Employee Handbook 2025

Chapter 1: Company Overview

NovaTech Solutions was founded in 2018 by Dr. Elena Vasquez and Marcus Chen in Austin, Texas. The company specialises in building AI-powered supply-chain optimisation tools for mid-size manufacturers. As of January 2025, NovaTech employs 342 people across four offices located in Austin, Toronto, Berlin, and Singapore.

The company mission statement is: "Empowering manufacturers with intelligent automation to reduce waste, cut costs, and deliver faster." NovaTech's flagship product is called OptiFlow, a cloud-based platform that uses machine learning to predict demand, optimise inventory levels, and route shipments efficiently. OptiFlow currently serves over 1,200 enterprise customers in 38 countries.

Chapter 2: Work Policies

All full-time employees receive 22 days of paid vacation per year, plus 10 public holidays. Vacation days increase to 27 days after five years of continuous employment. Sick leave is unlimited but requires a medical certificate for absences longer than three consecutive days.

Remote work is permitted up to three days per week for most roles. Employees must be available during core hours, which are 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM in their local time zone. Friday is designated as a "no-meetings" day to allow deep focus work.

The standard work week is 40 hours. Overtime must be pre-approved by a direct manager and is compensated at 1.5 times the normal hourly rate. Employees in engineering roles are eligible for on-call rotations, which include an additional stipend of \$500 per on-call week.

Chapter 3: Benefits and Compensation

NovaTech offers a competitive benefits package. Health insurance is fully covered for employees and 75 percent covered for dependents through BlueCross Premium Plan. The company matches 401(k) contributions up to 6 percent of the employee's salary.

An annual learning budget of \$3,000 is provided to each employee for courses, conferences, or certifications. Employees can also apply for a one-time educational grant of up to \$15,000 for degree programmes related to their role.

The performance review cycle occurs twice a year, in March and September. Bonuses range from 5 percent to 20 percent of annual salary based on individual and company performance. The average bonus paid in 2024 was 12 percent.

Chapter 4: Technology and Security

All employees are issued a company laptop running either macOS or Linux, based on preference. Windows machines are available upon special request. The company uses Google Workspace for email and collaboration, Slack for messaging, and Jira for project management.

Two-factor authentication (2FA) is mandatory for all company accounts. Passwords must be at least 16 characters long and rotated every 90 days. The IT security team conducts quarterly penetration testing and annual SOC 2 Type II audits. NovaTech achieved ISO 27001 certification in 2023.

All source code is stored in GitHub Enterprise. The company follows a trunk-based development workflow with mandatory code reviews. Each pull request requires approval from at least two reviewers before merging.

Chapter 5: Environmental and Social Responsibility

NovaTech has committed to achieving carbon neutrality by 2028. The company currently offsets 80 percent of its carbon emissions through verified reforestation projects in Brazil and Kenya. All four offices run on 100 percent renewable energy.

The NovaTech Foundation donates 1 percent of annual revenue to STEM education programmes in underserved communities. In 2024, the foundation distributed \$2.4 million in grants to 35 non-profit organisations across 12 countries.

Employees are given two paid volunteer days per year to support causes of their choice. The company also organises an annual hackathon focused on social-impact projects, with the winning team receiving \$25,000 in funding to develop their prototype further.